

MODEL UNITED NATIONS

PROFESSIONAL DELEGATE HANDBOOK

This handbook has been professionally prepared to guide delegates through all major aspects of Model United Nations, including Rules of Procedure, caucuses, diplomacy, public speaking, position papers, resolutions, bloc formation, formal terminology, committee flow, and strategies for high-level participation.

1. What is Model United Nations (MUN)?

Model United Nations is an academic simulation of the United Nations where students act as delegates representing countries. Delegates debate global issues, negotiate with other countries, draft resolutions, and attempt to solve international problems diplomatically.

2. What Does a Delegate Do?

As a delegate, your responsibility is to represent your assigned country — not your personal opinions. You must research your country's policies, alliances, enemies, economy, military interests, and diplomatic stance regarding the agenda.

3. Basic MUN Vocabulary (Buzz Words)

Agenda: The topic being debated.

Delegate: A participant representing a country.

Chair: The person managing the committee session.

Placard: The country name card used during debate and voting.

GSL (General Speakers List): Formal list where delegates give speeches.

Motion: A formal proposal to change the flow of debate.

Moderated Caucus (Mod): Structured debate on a specific subtopic.

Unmoderated Caucus (Unmod): Informal discussion where delegates move around and negotiate.

Bloc: A group of countries working together because of similar interests.

Working Paper: Informal document containing proposed solutions.

Draft Resolution: Official proposed solution document submitted for voting.

Point of Order: Raised when rules are violated.

Point of Information: A question directed to a speaker.

Right of Reply: Response to a direct insult or misrepresentation.

4. How a Typical MUN Committee Flows

Step 1: Roll Call — delegates answer "Present" or "Present and Voting."

Step 2: Setting the Agenda — committee decides topic if multiple agendas exist.

Step 3: Opening Speeches — delegates deliver country positions through the GSL.

Step 4: Moderated Caucuses — focused speeches on specific subtopics.

Step 5: Unmoderated Caucuses — delegates negotiate and form blocs.

Step 6: Working Papers — blocs prepare solution ideas.

Step 7: Draft Resolutions — formal UN-style solution documents are submitted.

Step 8: Voting Procedure — delegates vote on draft resolutions.

Step 9: Resolution Passes or Fails.

5. Understanding Moderated Caucuses (Mods)

A moderated caucus is a formal mini-debate focused on one subtopic. The chair chooses speakers one by one. **Example Motion:**

"The delegate of Pakistan motions for a 10-minute moderated caucus with 45-second speaking time on maritime security." **Purpose:**

- Attack or defend policies.
- Influence other delegates.
- Show leadership.

6. Understanding Unmoderated Caucuses (Unmods)

During an unmoderated caucus, delegates leave their seats and freely discuss ideas with others. This is where real diplomacy happens. **What Happens in Unmods?** • Formation of blocs.

- Negotiation between countries.
- Writing working papers.
- Building alliances.
- Convincing others to support your solutions.

7. What is a Bloc?

A bloc is a group of countries with similar interests and policies. Strong blocs often dominate committee discussions and resolutions. **Examples:** • Western Bloc.

- Gulf Bloc.
- Developing Countries Bloc.
- NATO Allies.
- Neutral States.

8. Position Paper Writing

A position paper is a formal document explaining your country's stance on the agenda. **A Good Position Paper Includes:**

1. Background of the issue.
2. Your country's position.
3. Actions already taken by your country.
4. Proposed solutions.

Tips:

- Write formally.
- Use diplomatic language.
- Never write personal opinions.
- Mention treaties and UN actions.

9. How to Give a Strong Speech

Structure of a Speech:

1. Greeting the committee.
 2. State your country's concern.
-

3. Explain your policy.
4. Suggest solutions.
5. End diplomatically.

Example Opening:

"Honourable Chair, distinguished delegates, the delegation of Japan believes that maritime stability is essential for international peace and economic security."

10. Time Durations in MUN

Opening Speeches: Usually 60–90 seconds.

Moderated Caucuses: 5–20 minutes total with 30–60 second speaking time.

Unmoderated Caucuses: 10–30 minutes.

Voting Procedure: Depends on committee size.

Entire Committee Session: Usually 2–6 hours depending on conference.

11. How to Win Best Delegate

Winning MUN awards is not only about speaking frequently. **Judges Look For:**

- Strong research.
- Diplomatic behavior.
- Leadership.
- Public speaking.
- Resolution writing.
- Cooperation with others.
- Confidence and professionalism.

Golden Rule:

The best delegates lead debate while remaining diplomatic and respectful.

12. Rookie Mistakes to Avoid

- Speaking emotionally instead of diplomatically.
- Ignoring your country policy.
- Staying silent during unmods.
- Being aggressive or disrespectful.
- Reading speeches word-for-word.
- Forgetting formal language.
- Making unrealistic solutions.

13. Formal Phrases Every Delegate Should Know

- "The delegation of ____ believes..."
- "Would the delegate yield to a point of information?"
- "The delegation strongly encourages..."
- "We urge the international community..."
- "We remain committed to diplomacy..."
- "The delegate motions for..."

14. Final Advice

Confidence comes from preparation. Research your country deeply, participate actively, and remain diplomatic. Remember: MUN is not a shouting competition — it is a diplomatic simulation. A calm, intelligent, and cooperative delegate often performs better than the loudest speaker.

Sample Timeline of a Committee Session

Stage	What Happens
Roll Call	Delegates answer Present / Present & Voting
Opening Speeches	Countries explain positions
Moderated Caucus	Formal debate on subtopics
Unmoderated Caucus	Negotiation and bloc formation
Working Papers	Solution brainstorming begins
Draft Resolution	Formal UN-style document created
Voting	Committee votes on resolutions